JINGCHEN ZHU

China Telephone: +86 15901080562

US Telephone: +1 617-251-5076

email: zhujingchen@stu.pku.edu.cn/jzhu6314@gmail.com

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EDUCATION

RDFZ Beijing, China

High school Sep. 2015 – Jul. 2018

Guanghua School of Management, Peking University Beijing, China

Bachelor in Economics Sep. 2018 – Jul. 2022

Guanghua School of Management, Peking University Beijing, China

Candidate for Ph.D. in Economics Sep. 2022 –

- Supervisor: *Yuyu Chen* and *Hui Wang*

Center for International Development, Harvard Kennedy School Cambridge, Massachusetts, USA

Visiting PhD Fellow Aug. 2025 – Feb. 2026

- Host: *David Yang*, *Jie Bai*, and *Jaya Wen*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- My research lies at the intersection of **organizational economics, behavioral economics, and political economy**. I combine proprietary within-firm data, field experiments, and surveys to study digital transformation and AI adoption, particularly among firms in developing countries. I examine how digital and AI-enabled technologies affect firm performance and organizational outcomes, how they interact with traditional management practices, and what barriers firms face in adopting and effectively using them.
- **A central part of my research is conducted in collaboration with firms across a range of industries.** In a large manufacturing company, I studied how the digitalization of production processes and managerial task allocation can improve talent retention by reducing employee burnout. I also conducted a field experiment at a construction company to examine how giving workers greater voice affects conformity. My current work with a large livestock company investigates how the introduction of AI into production processes shapes organizational attention and responsiveness.
- **A new strand of my research extends this firm-centered approach to questions in international trade and political economy.** I have recently begun collaborating with Chinese internet companies expanding into overseas markets to study how geopolitical competition shapes the cross-border operation of mobile applications. This research examines how firms adapt their international operations and market strategies to an increasingly fragmented global environment.

WORKING PAPERS

Specialization and Integration: Role-Differentiated Learning within Organizations

with *Yuyu Chen*, *Miguel Espinosa*, *Yu Wang*, and *Xinjue Yao*

Strategic Management Journal Revise & Resubmit

Digital Monitoring, Managerial Skill and Workers' Productivity

with *Yuyu Chen*, *Miguel Espinosa*, and *Shuo Liu*

Submitted to *Strategic Management Journal*

Accepted by *SMS 46th Annual Conference*, Strategic Human Capital Interest Group Best Paper Award

SMS Berlin Honorable Mention (3rd in Best Paper Finalist)

WORK IN PROGRESS

AI Detection, Attention, and Organizational Adaptation

With *Xinyao Qiu* and *Yuyu Chen*

Geopolitics and the Direction of App Innovation

With *Ziying Li* and *Yuyu Chen*

Consumer Resources and Relational Contract: Evidence from a Livestreaming Platform

With *Yuyu Chen, Bo Hu,* and *Qingxu Yang*

Worker Voice and Technology Adoption

With *Jing Cai* and *Yuyu Chen*

The Transmission of Gender Bias: Evidence from Mining in Africa

with *Dingxi Yan*

Incentive Inference and Conspiratorial Thinking

with *Qingxu Yang*

RESEARCH ASSISTANT EXPERIENCES

Research Assistant to Prof. Victor Aguirregabiria, Robert Clark, and Hui Wang Oct. 2022 – Dec. 2024

- "The Geographic Flow of Bank Funding and Access to Credit: Branch Networks, Local Synergies and Competition", Victor Aguirregabiria, Robert Clark, and Hui Wang. 2025, *American Economic Review*, Vol. 115, No. 6, pp 1818–56.
- Responsibility: Programing for estimation and counterfactual analysis

Research Assistant to Dr. Franklin Qian Jan. 2020 – Mar. 2020

TEACHING ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

- 2025, 2026 Spring: Intermediate Microeconomics (by Xincheng Qiu)
- 2024 Autumn: Development Economics (by Lukas Hensel)
- 2022, 2023, 2024 Spring: Intermediate Microeconomics (by Li'an Zhou), *excellent TA awards.*
- 2022, 2023, 2024 Autumn: Econ101 (by Qiao Liu, Yuyu Chen, and Hui Wang), *excellent TA awards.*
- 2022 Autumn: Behavioral Economics (by Juanjuan Meng)
- 2023 Spring: Organizational Economics (by Shuo Liu)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Computer Skills: Stata, Matlab, Python, R, LaTeX, and QGIS

Language Skills: English (fluent, IELTS 7.0, TOEFL 103), Mandarin (native).